

Week 6 Cram Sheet

Night-Before Recall + Quick Reference

Lecture 6 · Lixing Lao, Ph.D., L.Ac., MB · Topic: Inspection — Vitality, Color, Sense Organs, Hair/Nails/Skin, Secretions, Pediatric Dx

1 · Framework				Su Wen 32 — Face Heat Map		
Method	Uses			Region	Organ	
Inspection	Eyes: vitality, color, appearance, secretions (incl. tongue)			L cheek (patient's)	Liver	
Auscult./Olfact.	Ears (listen) + nose (smell)			Forehead	Heart	
Inquiry	Verbal questioning			Nose	Spleen	
Palpation	Touch, incl. pulse			R cheek (patient's)	Lung	
				Chin	Kidney	
Quick Recall: Zang-Xiang = inside shows outside.				Quick Recall: Face-forward pictures mirror this — patient's left is on YOUR right.		
2 · Shen (Vitality)				3 · Five Colors of Face		
Observation	Having Shen	Loss of Shen	False Shen	Color	Indication	
Complexion	Bright/moist	Dim, dull	Dull→sudden lustrous	Red	Heat (excess=whole face; malar only=yin-def heat)	
Eyes	Alert, twinkle	Dull, blurred	Dull→sudden bright	Pale/White	Cold, blood/yang deficiency (puffy=yang qi def; withered=blood def)	
Mind	Clear, agile	Unconscious/delirious	Sudden change	Yellow	Deficiency, damp (bright=yang jaundice/damp-heat; smoky=yin jaundice)	
Motion	Quick, appropriate	Sluggish, slow	Suddenly responsive	Blue-Green	Cold, pain, stagnation, convulsion	
Respiration	Even	Rapid/feeble/difficult	Feeble→brief steady	Dark Grey/Black	Kidney deficiency, blood stasis	
				Quick Recall: Lustrous=good prognosis. Dark/haggard=poor prognosis.		
Heads Up — False Shen = sudden brightening in a critical patient. Warning sign, NOT recovery.				Heads Up — Homework format = 5-color comparison table w/ case example. Expect similar on quiz.		
Deranged Shen				Secretions: Color Rule		
Presentation						
Fán zào	Irritability + hot/feverish sensation					
Zàng zào	Depression, hallucination, crying spells, no LOC					
Bái hé bìng	Chronic depression, mumbling, insomnia, sleepwalking					
Diǎn (Yin madness)	Chronic depression, mumbling, inappropriate laugh/cry					
Kuáng (Yang madness)	Raving, aggression, wandering naked, obscenities					
4 · Appearance, Body Shape & Movement				5 · Eyes: Five Wheels		
Body Shape				Wheel	Structure	Organ
Finding	Pattern			Blood	Inner/outer canthus	Heart
Overweight + depression	Qi deficiency + excess phlegm-damp			Qi	Sclera	Lung
Thin person, dry skin	Blood insufficiency			Wind	Iris	Liver
Great weight loss, long illness	Exhaustion of essential Qi			Water	Pupil	Kidney
Large barrel chest/epigastrium	Full (excess) lung/stomach condition			Flesh	Eyelids (upper=Spleen, lower=Stomach)	Spleen/Stomach
Large, overweight thighs	Spleen not transforming/transporting					
Thin body overall	Yin deficiency			Heads Up — Right Chi pulse = PC/San Jiao, NOT Kidney. Don't confuse w/ eye-wheel Kidney=pupil.		
Overweight body overall	Yang deficiency with phlegm					
Movement & Posture				Eye Color		
Finding	Pattern			Color	Pattern	
Active movement	Yang syndrome			Bright yellow (tangerine-peel)	Damp-heat, heat predominant	
Passive manner	Yin syndrome			Dull, dusky yellow	Damp-heat, damp predominant	
Violent limb movement	Wind disease (tetanus, infantile convulsion)			Dull, dark yellow	Cold-damp	
Muscle weakness/atrophy	Wei syndrome			Deep yellow + bloodshot	Toxic heat in the blood level	
Pain+swelling+restricted joints	Bi syndrome (painful obstruction)			Dull, dark yellow-brown	Blood stasis (dark rings, purple tongue)	
One-sided numbness	Hemiplegia / wind-stroke			Red (inner/outer canthus)	Heart fire (or SI, if outer canthus)	
Quick movement + heat	Excess Yang			Red, entire eye + headache	Rising Liver fire	
Slow movement + cold	Deficiency Yin			Red sclera, sore throat, cough	Exterior wind-heat affecting Lung	
				Color	Pattern	
				Sudden red + itching + aversion to cold	Exterior invasion of wind-heat	

Finding	Pattern
Small, restless fidgeting	Empty (deficiency) heat
Tremors, convulsions	Wind (involuntary movement)
Paralysis	Internal wind
Stiffness/rigidity	Qi stagnation, blood stasis, and/or wind

Quick Recall: Active/fast/hot=Yang excess. Passive/slow/cold=Yin deficiency.

Eye Color (cont.)		Eye Shape/Move (cont.)	
Color	Pattern	Presentation	Pattern
Blue-green	Liver wind (tremor, dizziness, numbness, paralysis)	Deviation + nausea, vomiting, greasy coat	Wind-damp-phlegm obstruction
Bluish	Internal cold, or Kidney Yin deficiency	Both eyes deviate up/high fever/coma	Extreme heat generating wind
Dark sclera (crab-eye black)	Accumulated heat	Deviation after trauma	Blood stasis
Dark eye sockets, sunken	Liver & Kidney Yin deficiency	Congenital deviation	Essence deficiency (Kidney)
White rings around iris	Turbid phlegm	Frequent spasms, dry itchy eyes, pale, steady pulse	Blood deficiency
Cloudy white iris	Liver & Kidney Yin deficiency	Eyelids heavy/tired feeling	Spleen Qi deficiency
Pale white vessels in canthus	Blood or Yang deficiency	Occasional spasm + red/itchy + fever/chills	Exterior invasion (wind-heat)
Quick Recall: Yellow=damp, Red=heat/fire, Blue-green=wind/cold, Black/dark=extreme heat OR cold, White=deficiency/phlegm.		Droopy eyelids (ptosis)	Qi sinking, or wind attacking channels

Eye Shape & Movement

Presentation	Pattern
Bulging/protruding + anger, red tongue, yellow greasy coat	Liver Yang rising w/ heat+damp
Protruding + neck swelling, tinnitus, 5-center heat	Liver Yin def. w/ relative Yang excess
Sunken + slight cough, weak voice	Lung deficiency
Sunken + poor appetite, distention, limb weakness	Spleen deficiency
Sunken, sudden onset, deep/scattered pulse	Yin/Yang collapse (severe)
Swollen, sudden onset, no color change	Fluid malfunction (Spleen def. w/ damp)
Bags under the eyes	Spleen & Kidney deficiency
Strabismus, sudden, no redness/swelling	Wind attacking channels

6 • Nose	
Lung (5-phase) + Spleen (facial map, both Su Wen & Ling Shu).	
Finding	Pattern
Green/blue tip	Cold
Yellow tip	Damp (+heat if thirst/sweat)
White tip	Blood deficiency
Red tip	Heat
Gray tip	Impaired water → edema
Green bridge	Liver Qi stagnation
Dark purple bridge	Blood stasis
Red bridge	Liver fire
Finding	Pattern
Dry and black	Toxic heat
Flaring nostrils	Extreme heat
Epistaxis	Excess heat, blood forced out
Swollen nose	Excess condition
Sunken nose	Deficiency condition
Nasal polyps	Stagnated heat in Yangming channel
Quick Recall: Normal nose = slightly moist and shiny.	
Edema Starts In	Organ
Upper body/head	Lung
Lower body/feet	Kidney
4 limbs/torso	Spleen

7 • Ears	8 • Teeth
Kidney opens to ear.	Kidney — teeth are the "surplus of bone."

Finding	Pattern	Finding	Pattern
Swelling/pain, middle ear	Heat in the Shaoyang	White, moist, bright/clean	Strong Kidney Qi
Dry/withered/black auricle, chronic illness	Kidney essence exhausted	Dry, no sheen	Kidney Yin decline
Purulent discharge ("Tin Er")	Damp-heat Liver/GB	Yellowing, gradual w/ age	Normal aging
Thin ear	Qi/Blood deficiency	Sudden dull yellow (soybean)	Kidney deficiency
Long, full earlobes	Strong constitution	Gray and black (black bean)	Exhaustion of Yin and Yang
Small earlobes	Poor constitution	Dry, black, gray	Kidney Yin deficiency
Shiny, moist earlobes	Good prognosis	Tartar, grimy yellow	Stomach turbidity
Dry, withered earlobes	Poor prognosis / Kidney Qi exhaustion	Burnt and dry	Kidney & Stomach Yin deficiency
Finding	Pattern	Finding	Pattern
Yellow/white pus discharge	Kidney Yin def. w/ fire, or Liver/GB damp-heat	Delayed baby/adult teeth	Essence and Jing deficiency
Ear color: white	Sudden wind-cold invasion	Deviated growth / missing	Insufficient Yangming Qi
Ear color: green/black	Pain	Loss of teeth in adult, receding gums	Fire flaring up from Kidney Yin def.
Ear color: black	Kidney failure		
Ear color: red	Excess heat (possibly damp-heat)		
Ear color: yellow	Damp accumulation		

Tinnitus	Organ
High-pitch (cicada)	Liver
Low-pitch (water)	Kidney

Gums (Spleen/Stomach)		Throat & Tonsils (Stomach+Lung)	
Finding	Pattern	Finding	Pattern
Moist, deep red (normal)	Normal	Deep red throat/pharynx	Heat
Deep red + swelling	Excess heat / Stomach fire	Pale red throat	Empty (deficiency) heat
Pale	Blood deficiency	Acute pain+redness+swelling	Wind invasion (exterior)
Atrophied	Kidney deficiency	Chronic redness/swelling	Interior Stomach heat
Blue line between teeth/gums	Mercury poisoning	Chronic sore/dry, NOT swollen/red	Lung/Kidney Yin def., empty heat
Swollen, ulcerated, bleeding	Stomach fire pushing blood out	Erosion, redness, swelling, yellowish-red	Heat in Stomach/Intestines
Lips & Mouth (Spleen)		Chronic erosion, comes and goes	Empty (deficiency) heat
		Chronic erosion, hard raised ulcers	Blood stasis with phlegm-heat
Finding	Pattern	Finding	Pattern
Pale lips	Blood deficiency	Swollen tonsils, normal color	Damp/phlegm retention, Qi deficiency bg.
Blue-purplish lips	Retention of cold OR blood stagnation	Chronically red/swollen tonsils	Heat or toxic heat, Stomach/LI
Bright red lips	Heat toxins	Acutely red/swollen tonsils	Wind-heat invasion w/ toxicity
Crimson lips	Yin-deficiency heat	Acute red/swollen with exudate	Heat toxins, Stomach/LI (vs. cold)
Dry, red lips	Heat damaging fluids		
Purple lips	Blood stasis (stabbing pain)		
Deviated mouth	Wind		
Mouth slightly open	Deficiency pattern		
Finding	Pattern		
Mouth remains open + fever/thirst/canker sores	Excess heat		
Breathing through open mouth	Empty/deficiency pattern		
Open mouth + SOB + frothy sputum	Lung deficiency w/ phlegm stagnation		
Sudden attack, drooling, LOC	Wind		

9 • Hair		Skin	
Blood + Kidney Essence. Women ruled by Blood, men by Qi.		Finding	Pattern
Finding	Pattern	Lustrous, harmonious (normal)	Normal
Original color, shiny, lustrous, moist	Sufficient Blood/Kidney essence	Red	Heat
Premature graying	Depletion of Kidney essence	Yellow, orangish	Damp-heat, more heat than damp
Dull, brittle, easily broken	Kidney essence or Liver Blood def.	Yellow, dusky	Damp-heat, more damp than heat
Thick, lustrous	Sufficient Blood/Kidney essence	Too moist	Lung not controlling fluids
Thin, sparse	Deficiency of Kidney	Dry	Blood/fluid deficiency
Thinning/falling out, general	Blood deficiency	Dark, with scales	Blood stasis
Falling out in patches	Blood deficiency within channels	Itching	Wind
Nails		Finding	Pattern
Reflect the Liver.		Pitting edema (upper→down)	Yang edema, Spleen/Kidney Yang def.
		Non-pitting edema	Qi stagnation or dampness
		Edema from feet up, worse below	Yin edema
Finding	Pattern	Skin Lesions	
Pink, normal luster	Sufficient Qi	Lesion	Description
Dark red	Heat	Papule	Raised, red, seed-sized; fades w/ pressure
Pale	Blood deficiency or cold	Macule	Flat red patch; does NOT fade w/ pressure
Blanch returns immediately	Sufficient Qi and Blood	Blister	Fluid-filled, thick or thin walls
Blanch returns slowly	Exhaustion of Qi and Blood	Nodule	Palpable, solid, round
Withered, dried	Liver/Kidney Yin insufficiency; chronic Bi	Term	Cause
Atrophied / peeled	Yin deficiency	Yong — Yang carbuncle	Internal accumulation of fire toxins
Soft and thin	Deficiency of Blood	Ju — Yin carbuncle	Insufficient Qi/Blood + Qi/Yin/cold stagnation
Finding	Pattern	Ding — boil/furuncle	Exogenous wind-fire toxins, surface heat
Rough, thick, dull, no transparency	Qi/Blood deficiency with wind	Jie — furuncle	Stagnated Qi/Blood from damp-heat in skin
Longitudinal striping	Liver Blood def., trauma, fungal infection		
Brittle	Blood deficiency, wind, or trauma		
Hook-shaped	Qi/Blood stagnation, wind-Bi		
Spoon-shaped	Qi/Blood stag., malnutrition, Spleen def.		
Ridged	Kidney Yin def., Liver Yang rising, Blood def.		
Bluish thenar veins	Cold in the Stomach		
Short bluish thenar veins	Empty (deficiency) pattern		

Finding	Pattern
Red thenar veins	Heat
Purple thenar veins	Blood stasis

10 · Secretions/Excretions Logic			11 · Infant Finger Venous Diagnosis	
Applies to nasal discharge, sputum, stool, vaginal discharge alike.			Age <3. Left index finger=boys, right index finger=girls.	
Axis	Cold/Deficient	Hot/Excess	Gate Reached	Severity
Color	White	Yellow	Wind Gate only	Mild illness / exterior pathogen
Consistency	Thin, clear, watery	Thick, sticky	Qi Gate	Interior condition, stronger illness
			Life Gate	Severe illness
Quantity	Profuse	Scanty	Past Life Gate to tip	Life-threatening
Odor	None/faint	Strong	Vein Color	Indication
<i>Quick Recall: White/thin/profuse/no-odor = cold-deficiency. Yellow/thick/scanty/strong-odor = heat-excess.</i>			Light red, not very visible	Normal
			Bright red	Heat
			Purple	Stronger heat, creating stasis
			Green or dark blue	Wind

12 · Constitutional Types (Flagged)			Five-Element Body Types (Ling Shu 64)		
Heads Up — Scope conflict: Prof. Lao’s recorded lecture says "Nothing on the body constitutions" will be tested. Prof. Schrier’s own deck devotes ~9/41 slides to it. Confirm with him which governs the quiz.			Element	Physical	Personality
Weak vs. Strong Constitution (Ling Shu 54)			Wood	Green complexion, small head, long face, broad shoulders, tall, sinewy	Superior talent, hardworking, survives sickness
			Fire	Red complexion, small head/hands/feet, curly/little hair, walks fast+sways	Frivolous w/ wealth, passionate, impulsive, curious
			Earth	Yellow complexion, round face, big head, wide jaws, large abdomen	Dignified, calm, unassertive, likes helping people
			Metal	Pale complexion, square face, flat abdomen, strong voice	Honest, upright, rational, leadership aptitude
			Water	Dark complexion, big head, wrinkles, round body, swaying gait	Laid-back, unafraid, tendency to deceive, always moving
			<i>Quick Recall: Wood=tall/hardworking. Fire=curly/impulsive. Earth=round/calm. Metal=square/honest. Water=dark/deceptive.</i>		
Cause of Weak Constitution					
Parents' general health					
Health at time of conception					
Mother's health during pregnancy					
Parental age/pregnancy events (stress, trauma, drugs/alcohol/smoking)					
Heads Up — Constitution is not fixed: Pre-Heavenly (Jing) essence is the basis; Post-Heavenly Qi (diet, herbs, acupuncture, <i>yang sheng</i>) can improve it.					